plush

A FREE GUIDE FROM PLUSH

Know Your Water

What's in your city's water, and what to do about it.

1. Read your city's water report
2. Build a better shower routine
3. Get the most from your Plush



BEFORE YOU START

You chose your shampoo. Nobody chose your water.



Everything on your shower shelf was picked by you. The water came with the apartment, the house, the city.

This guide shows you what's in it, in plain words. Then it builds a better shower routine around it, step by step.

01 **Know your water**
Find your city's water report and read it in 30 seconds. pages 3–9

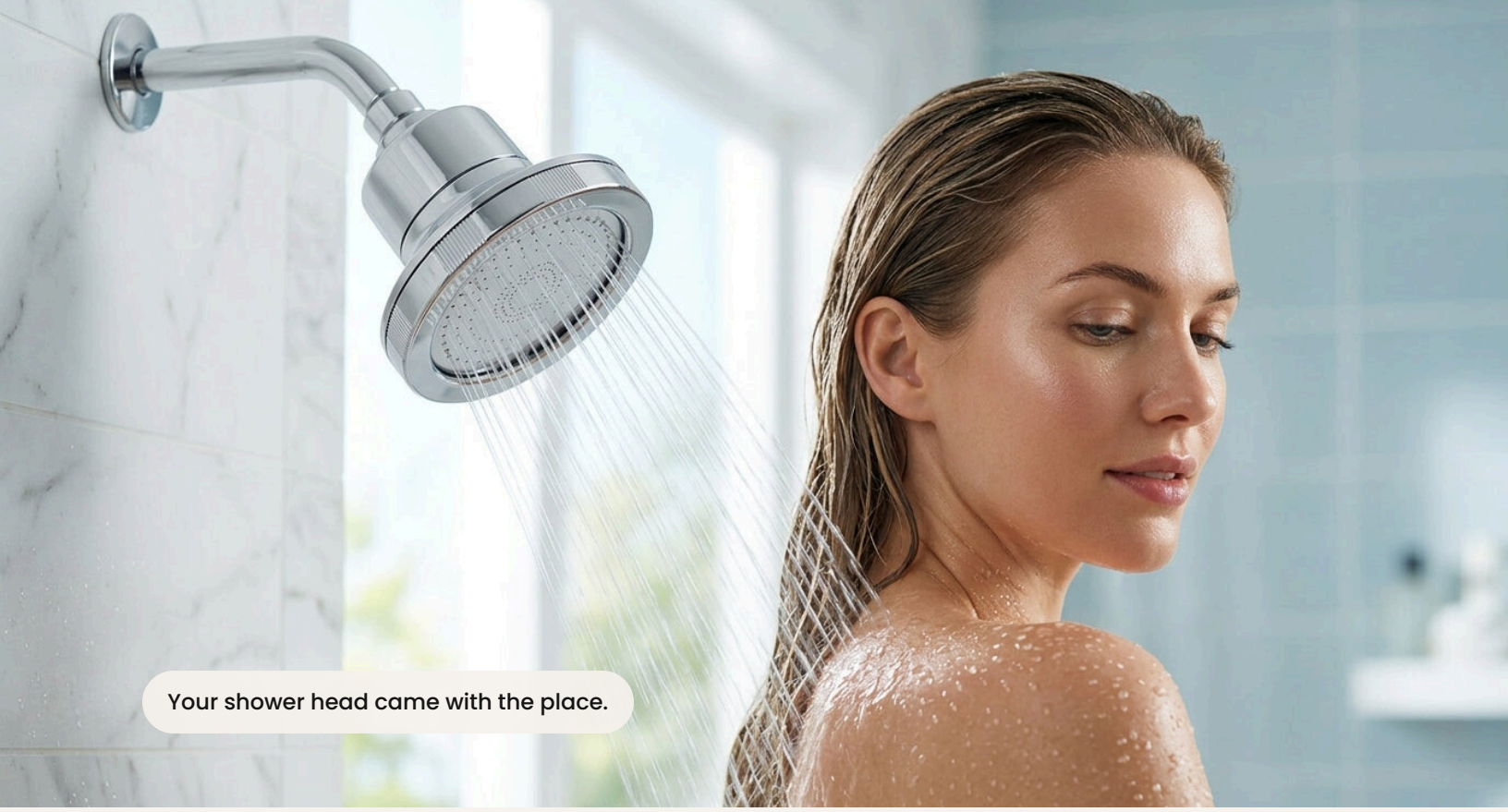
02 **Your shower routine**
Six daily habits, a 10-minute shower, and what to do each week. pages 10–14

03 **Your Plush**
How it works, the install, Day 30 and your next cartridge. pages 15–20

No scare tactics, no lab coat. Your city's own numbers, what they mean, and simple habits you can start tonight.

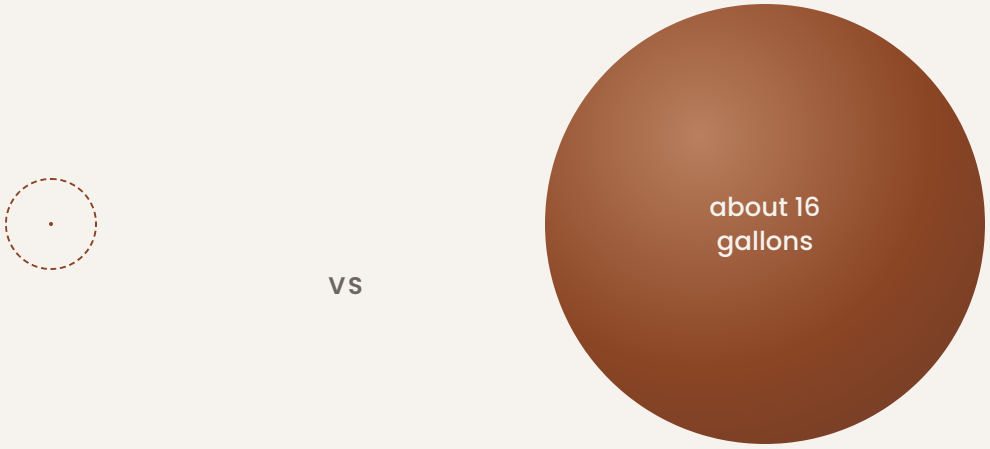
Thanks for being here.

Yasser
CEO, Plush



PART 1 · KNOW YOUR WATER

The biggest ingredient in your routine



VS

1 teaspoon

of shampoo

About 12,000 teaspoons

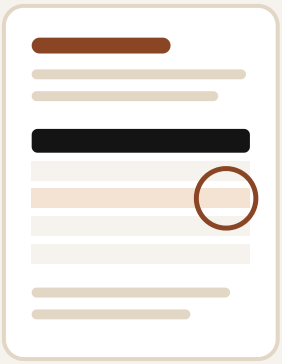
of water, in one shower

A typical shower runs about 16 gallons through your shower head. Shower every day and that's nearly 6,000 gallons a year. **Your hair and skin meet that water before they meet any product.** So it's worth knowing what's in it.

Typical shower: about 16 gallons over about 8 minutes (Alliance for Water Efficiency, Home Water Works). 1 U.S. teaspoon is about 4.9 mL. Circles drawn to scale by area.

01

Your water has a report card



It's called a Consumer Confidence Report, or CCR. Some cities call it a Water Quality Report. Same thing.

Who has to publish it

Every community water system in the U.S. That's any system serving at least 25 people, or 15 homes, all year. If you pay a water bill to a city or a utility, you're covered. The rule comes from the Safe Drinking Water Act.

When

Every year, by July 1. It covers the year before. So the report you'll find this year shows last year's tests.

What's in it

Where it comes from

A river, a lake, a reservoir, or groundwater from wells.

How it's treated

The steps your utility uses before the water reaches your pipes.

What was detected

Every regulated substance found in testing, with the level measured.

Any violations

Whether a legal limit was exceeded, and what the utility did about it.

> **On a private well?** Wells aren't covered by these reports. You'd have to test the water yourself, with a certified lab.

The report talks about drinking water. Your shower runs on the same water, from the same pipes. **Your shower head is the last stop before it reaches you.**

02

Find yours in 3 minutes

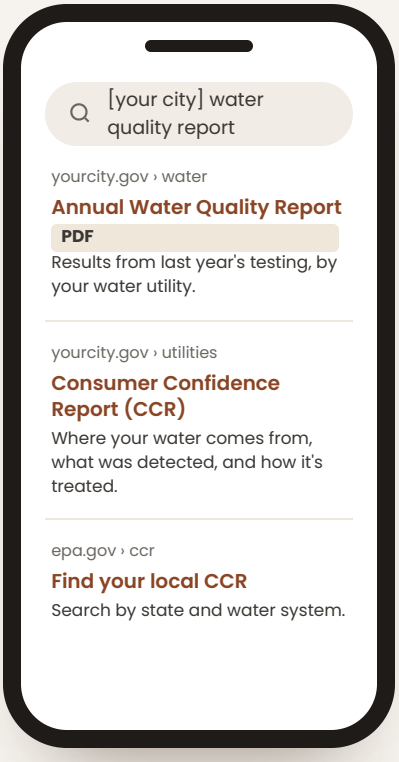
Four ways. The first one works most of the time.

1. **Search for it**
   Type *"[your city] water quality report"* or *"[your city] consumer confidence report"*. Most utilities post it as a PDF on their website.

2. **Look at your water bill**
   The utility's name is on it. Many bills also print the link to the report, often near the bottom.

3. **Use the EPA's search**
   Go to **epa.gov/ccr** and use "Find your local CCR". Pick your state, then your water system.

4. **Call and ask**
   Call the number on your water bill and ask for the "Consumer Confidence Report". They're required to make it available to you.



> **Renting?** Your landlord may pay the water bill, but the report still covers your water. Search by your city or your utility's name.

Tip. Big cities sometimes have several water systems. If your report lists more than one, look for the area or ZIP code that matches your home.

Search screen above is an illustration. Your results will look different.

03

Read it in 30 seconds

Skip the intro pages. Go straight to the big table. It usually looks like this.

SUBSTANCE	UNIT	MCL 2	YOUR LEVEL 2	RANGE	VIOLATION 1	LIKELY SOURCE
Chlorine 3	ppm	MRDL 4	**1.2**	0.6 – 2.0	**No**	Water additive used to control microbes
Nitrate	ppm	10	**1.4**	ND – 2.8	**No**	Runoff from fertilizer use
Total trihalomethanes	ppb	80	**34**	18 – 51	**No**	By-product of drinking water disinfection

Example only. Numbers are made up to show the layout. Your city's table will have its own substances and numbers.

Look at three things, in this order

1. **The Violation column**
   "No" all the way down means every result was within the legal limits that year.

2. **Your level next to the MCL**
   The MCL is the legal limit. Your city's number should sit below it. The gap tells you how far below.

3. **The disinfectant line**
   It says "chlorine" or "chloramine". Write it down on your water card. Chapter 04 explains why it matters.

Detected doesn't mean unsafe. Reports list everything that was found, even at levels far below the limits. The report gives you the numbers. What you do with them is up to you.

03 · READ IT IN 30 SECONDS

The words, decoded

Every report uses the same short words. Here they are.

MCL	**Maximum Contaminant Level.** The highest level of a substance allowed in drinking water. It's the legal limit.
MCLG	**Maximum Contaminant Level Goal.** A goal set by the EPA, often lower than the MCL. It's a target, not a limit.
MRDL	**Maximum Residual Disinfectant Level.** The limit for disinfectants like chlorine and chloramine: 4 ppm.
AL	**Action Level.** Used for lead and copper. If too many homes test above it, the utility has to take extra steps.
90th %ile	For lead and copper: 90% of the homes tested were at or below this number.
TTHM, HAA5	By-products that form when disinfectants meet natural material in water. Reports list them with their own limits.
ND	**Not detected.** Testing didn't find it.
NA	**Not applicable.**

Units

UNIT	MEANS	SAME AS
ppm	parts per million	mg/L (milligrams per liter)
ppb	parts per billion	µg/L (micrograms per liter)



1 ppm is about one drop of water in a 13-gallon kitchen trash can full of water.



1 ppb is about one drop in 13,000 gallons. That's a backyard pool.

1 ppm = 1,000 ppb. Always compare numbers in the same unit. A drop is about 0.05 mL.

04

Chlorine or chloramine?

Your utility adds a disinfectant to keep the water clean all the way through the pipes to your tap. That's required, and it's a good thing.

Cl

Chlorine

The classic. It's the reason some showers smell a little like a swimming pool.

NH_2Cl

Chloramine

Chlorine combined with a small amount of ammonia. It lasts longer in big pipe networks, so many large cities use it.

More than one in five Americans gets water treated with chloramine, according to the EPA. Federal rules cap both at **4 ppm** (4 mg/L), as a yearly average.

How to know which one you have

Find the disinfectant line in your report. Look for **chlorine**, **free chlorine**, **total chlorine**, **chloramine**, **chloramines** or **monochloramine**. Still not sure? Your utility will tell you in one phone call.

Why it's worth knowing

Filters are built for specific jobs. Different filter materials handle different things, at different speeds. Knowing which disinfectant your city uses helps you judge any filter honestly, including ours.

> **Straight talk.** Plush's cartridge is built around chlorine. Chloramine is harder to filter for every kind of shower filter, ours included. If your city uses it, now you know what to expect.

A good question to ask any filter brand: "What is your cartridge designed to reduce, and was it tested?" A clear brand will give you a clear answer.

05

Hard water, in numbers

Hard water is water with a lot of dissolved calcium and magnesium. It's not a safety issue. It's what leaves white spots on your shower door.

Your report may list hardness in **mg/L** (sometimes written "as $CaCO_3$") or in **grains per gallon (gpg)**. To convert: **1 gpg = 17.1 mg/L**.

Soft	Moderately hard	Hard	Very hard
0 – 60 mg/L 0 – 3.5 gpg	61 – 120 mg/L 3.6 – 7 gpg	121 – 180 mg/L 7.1 – 10.5 gpg	over 180 mg/L over 10.5 gpg

Scale used by the U.S. Geological Survey.

What you'll notice

White spots

On glass doors, tiles and faucets, once the water dries.

A crust on the head

A white or tan crust around the holes of your shower head.

Less lather

Soap and shampoo that don't foam up as much as you'd expect.

> **Straight talk.** Plush is not a water softener. No shower filter removes hardness. If very hard water and white spots are your main problem, a water softener is the right tool. We'd rather tell you now.

Quick fix for spots. Wipe the glass with equal parts white vinegar and water, then rinse. A squeegee after each shower keeps them from coming back.

PART 2 · YOUR SHOWER ROUTINE

Upgrade the routine. Start with the water.

You've built a routine around products. This part rebuilds it around the one thing every product touches first.



1. **Six daily habits**
   The first one changes the water. The other five are free. Page 11.

2. **Your 10-minute shower**
   A simple order for hair-wash days. Page 12.

3. **Week, month, year**
   Small habits that keep everything in shape. Page 13.

The idea in one line. Products work on the surface. The water touches everything first. So a good routine starts at the shower head.

EVERY DAY

Six habits for a better shower

Five of them cost nothing. The first one is the only step that works on the water itself.

HABIT 1

Filter the water first

Every other step happens after the water has already reached you. Filtering at the shower head is the only step that changes the water itself, for every minute of every shower.

THIS IS WHERE PLUSH COMES IN

HABIT 2

Warm, not hot

Very hot water can leave skin feeling tight. Warm feels almost as good, without the tight feeling after.

HABIT 3

5 to 10 minutes

Plenty of time to wash and rinse. Longer just means more time under the water, and a bigger water bill.

HABIT 4

Scalp first, ends last

Shampoo goes on your scalp. Conditioner goes on the lengths and ends. Rinse both well.

HABIT 5

Pat, don't rub

Press the towel against your skin and hair. Put your lotion on while your skin is still a little damp.

HABIT 6

20 seconds of squeegee

Hard water dries into white spots. One pass on the glass after each shower, and it stays clear. Keep the squeegee on a hook inside the shower so you don't skip it.

HAIR-WASH DAYS

Your 10-minute shower



A simple order that works. On other days, skip the hair steps.

0:00 **Water on. Warm, not hot.**
Give it a few seconds to reach the right temperature.

0:30 **Wet your hair all the way.**
A full minute. Shampoo spreads better on hair that's soaked.

1:30 **Shampoo your scalp.**
Fingertips, not nails. The suds wash the lengths on their way down.

3:30 **Conditioner on the ends.**
Leave it in while you wash your body.

4:00 **Body wash.**
Your hands or a soft cloth. Save scrubs for once or twice a week.

7:00 **Rinse everything.**
Conditioner out, soap off. Take your time here.

9:00 **A cooler last rinse, if you like it.**
Totally optional. Some people love it.

9:30 **Water off. Squeegee. Pat dry.**
Then lotion, while your skin is still a little damp.

Every one of those 10 minutes runs through your shower head. That's why, in this routine, the filter comes first.

Body-only days

Water on, body wash, rinse, off. Five minutes is plenty.

Between hair washes

Keep your hair out of the water with a clip, or just rinse the scalp with water.

WEEK, MONTH, YEAR

Beyond the daily

A few small habits keep your shower, your hair and your filter in shape. Put them in your phone's calendar once, and forget about them.

Every week

- Hard water? A clarifying shampoo every week or two helps lift mineral and product buildup.
- Wipe the face of your shower head with a cloth and a little white vinegar.
- Wash your bath towels often. Damp towels get musty fast.

Every 30 days

- Day 30: unscrew your cartridge and look at it (page 17).
- Snap a photo next to a fresh one. It's the best way to see your water.

Every 3 months

- Change your cartridge. Go by the calendar, not the color (page 18).
- Set your next reminder the same day.

Every year, after July 1

- Your city publishes a new water report.
- Take 3 minutes to read it, and update your water card (page 19).

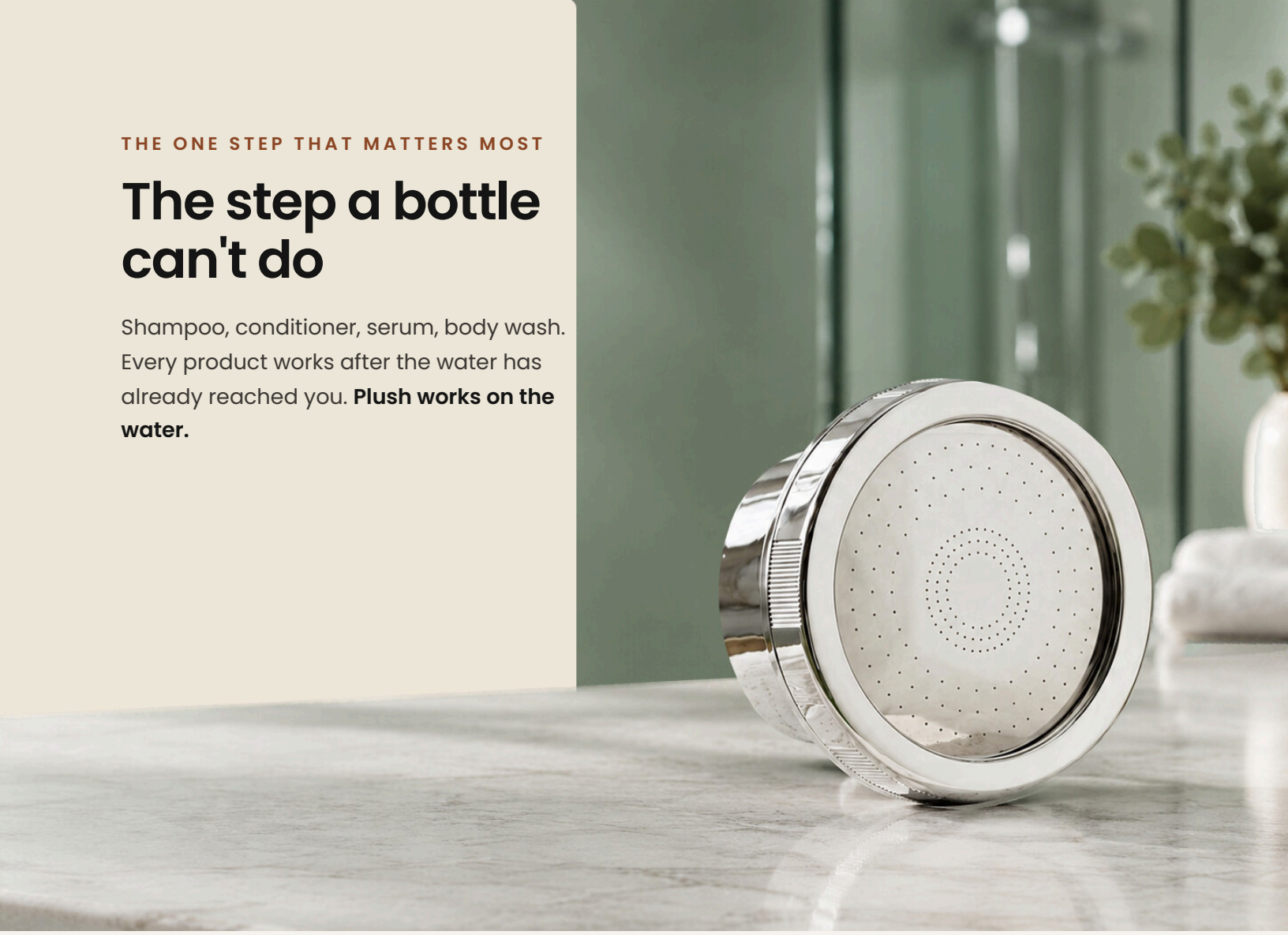
Your first 180 days with Plush



THE ONE STEP THAT MATTERS MOST

The step a bottle can't do

Shampoo, conditioner, serum, body wash. Every product works after the water has already reached you. **Plush works on the water.**



Your products

- Work on the surface
- Go on after the water
- Rinse off with that same water

Plush

- Sits between your pipes and you
- Filters the water as it flows
- Changes the one ingredient you never picked

32¢ a day About what a fresh cartridge every 3 months costs, for every shower you take. Plush Duo already includes your second cartridge.

60-day money back | **Free U.S. shipping** | **2-minute install**

Based on a $29 cartridge used for 3 months (90 days). Filter capabilities refer to what the filter is designed to reduce, not to the guaranteed presence of those substances in your water. Individual results vary.

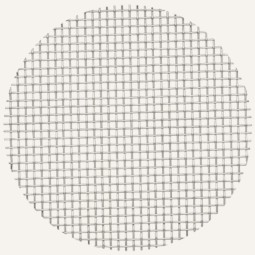
PART 3 · YOUR PLUSH

How Plush works

Water runs through the cartridge before it reaches you. Every layer has one job.



1. **Fine mesh and filter cotton**
   Catch sediment and particles before they reach you.
2. **KDF-55**
   Copper and zinc granules that turn free chlorine into chloride, the same chloride found in table salt.
3. **Calcium sulfite**
   Reacts with chlorine fast, even in hot water.
4. **Activated carbon**
   Catches leftover chlorine and the smell that comes with it.
5. **Vitamin C beads**
   One more layer that reacts with chlorine.



What it won't do: soften hard water. Removing calcium and magnesium takes a whole-home softener, not a shower head. We'd rather tell you now than on day 30.

Why the cartridge needs changing. Every layer works by reacting with or holding on to what passes through. Over time it fills up. That's why it gets a fresh start every 3 months.

Filter capabilities refer to what the filter is designed to reduce, not to the guaranteed presence of those substances in your water. Individual results vary. Plush is not a medical device and is not intended to diagnose, treat, cure or prevent any condition.

PART 3 · YOUR PLUSH

Install Plush in 2 minutes



If you can open a jar, you can install Plush. It fits the standard U.S. ½-inch shower arm. No tools, no plumber.

1. **Turn the water off.**

2. **Unscrew your old shower head by hand, counter-clockwise.**
   Stuck? Wrap it in a cloth and turn it gently with a wrench.

3. **Check the rubber washer inside the Plush head.**
   It's already in there. Leave it.

4. **Screw Plush on by hand, clockwise, until it stops.**
   Hand-tight is tight enough.

5. **Run the water for 30 seconds before your first shower.**
   A new filter can release a little carbon dust. It's normal, and it only happens once.

Moving out?

Keep your old shower head in a drawer. Swap it back the day you move out, and take Plush with you.

Something's off?

Email **info.tryplush@gmail.com**. A real person reads every message and replies within 2 business days.

DAY 30

Look at your cartridge

On day 30, unscrew your cartridge and hold it next to a fresh one. No fresh one at hand? Use this page.

DAY 0



DAY 30

Hold yours here

We didn't make it brown. Your water did.

What you see is what stayed in the cartridge instead of coming out of your shower head.

Every city's water is different, so every cartridge looks different. Some turn tan, some turn rust, some barely change. A color isn't a verdict on your water. It just shows you the filter at work.

Took a day-30 photo? Send it to **info.tryplush@gmail.com**. We'd love to see what you saw.

EVERY 3 MONTHS

A fresh cartridge, no tools



Go by the calendar, not the color. Depending on your water, a cartridge can look clean and still be used up.

1. **Turn the water off.**
2. **Unscrew the old cartridge, screw in the new one.**
   No tools needed.
3. **Run the water for 30 seconds.**
   Same as on day one.

Set the reminder now. Open your phone's calendar and add "New Plush cartridge" 3 months after your install date. Then again on the day you change it.

Never run out

Order your next cartridge at **myplush.us/products/plush-replacement-cartridge**

Your thank-you code for your next order:

PLUSHFAM

20% off your next order. One use per customer.

Got Plush Duo? Your second cartridge is already in the box. Day 90 is covered.

FILL IT IN ONCE

Your water card

Fill it in with your report open. Print it, or screenshot it and keep it on your phone.

City

Water utility

Report year

Water source ☐ River or lake ☐ Groundwater ☐ Both

Disinfectant ☐ Chlorine ☐ Chloramine ☐ Not sure

Hardness _____ mg/L or _____ gpg

Hardness level ☐ Soft ☐ Moderate ☐ Hard ☐ Very hard

Any violations? ☐ None ☐ Yes, for:

My Plush dates

Installed on

Day 30 look

Day 90: new cartridge

Day 180: new cartridge

Day 270: new cartridge

My routine

☐ Warm, not hot ☐ 5 to 10 minutes ☐ Pat, don't rub ☐ Squeegee

☐ Weekly clarifying wash

GOOD QUESTIONS

Straight answers

The questions we get the most, answered without the fine print.

Will Plush fit my shower?

Plush fits the standard U.S. ½-inch shower arm, the one in almost every home and apartment. If it doesn't fit yours, you have 60 days to send it back for a full refund.

Will it lower my water pressure?

Any filter sits in the water's path, so we won't promise you more pressure. Here's what we can promise: if it doesn't feel right in your shower, you have 60 days to send it back for a full refund.

Is Plush a water softener?

No. Removing the minerals in hard water takes a whole-home softener, not a shower head. Plush is made to reduce chlorine and catch sediment.

How often should I change the cartridge?

Every 3 months. Go by the calendar, not the color. With Plush Duo, your second cartridge is already in the box.

Why does my cartridge turn brown?

Depending on your water, your cartridge can come out darker than it went in. That's what it caught before the water reached you. We didn't make it brown. Your water did.

I'm renting. Is that okay?

Yes. No tools, no plumber, nothing to drill. Keep your old shower head in a drawer and swap it back the day you move out.

60 **Try it for 60 days.** On day 59, if you don't love it, you get all your money back. Email **info.tryplush@gmail.com** with your order number.

plush

City water in.
Plush water out.

Questions about your report, your shower or your order? Email **info.tryplush@gmail.com**. A real person reads every message, and we reply within 2 business days.



Sources. U.S. Environmental Protection Agency: Consumer Confidence Reports (epa.gov/ccr) and chloramines in drinking water. Federal disinfectant limits: 40 CFR 141.65. U.S. Geological Survey: hardness of water. Alliance for Water Efficiency, Home Water Works: shower water use.

This guide is for general information only and is not medical advice. Plush is not a medical device and is not intended to diagnose, treat, cure or prevent any condition. Plush is not a water softener. Filter capabilities refer to what the filter is designed to reduce, not to the guaranteed presence of those substances in your water. Individual results vary.

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